

Alaa Al Saad

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with a master's degree in cyber-Forensics and Security and hands-on experience in penetration testing, vulnerability analysis, and security auditing. Proven ability to identify critical system weaknesses and implement security improvements, including enhancing system security by up to 90% through penetration testing and strengthening organizational controls through ISO 27000 and NIST CSF frameworks. Certified CompTIA Security+ professional with expertise in risk assessment, incident response, and secure system design, committed to protecting organizational assets and strengthening cybersecurity resilience.

EDUCATION

Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, IL MAY 2024
Master of Cyber Forensics and Security, GPA, 3.9/4.0
Key Models: Cyber SecurityMgmt, Cyber SecurityTechnologies, VulnerabilityAnalysandCtrl, DatabaseSecurity, ITAuditing.

Imam Abdulrahman Bin Faisal University, Al Jubail, Saudi Arabia MAY 2016
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science, GPA 4.3/5.0
Key Models: Database Programming, System Analysis, Fundamentals of Networking and Communication, Operating Systems, Network Protocols, Computer Maintenance and Data Protection, Data Structures.

SKILLS

- **Analyzes program:** Wireshark | Nmap | Burp suite | Wappalyzer | Acunetix | Maltego.
- **Language:** Linux | SQL database.
- **Compliance and Standards:** ISO 27000 | NIST CSF | Security Auditing.
- **Security practice:** Penetration Testing | Vulnerability Analysis | Risk assessment | Incident Response | Network Security.
- **Technical Writing:** Security reports | Incident Documentation | Analysis Outcomes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Information Security instructor

college of business administration, Dammam

Aug.2024 – Dec.2025

- Delivered applied instruction in Information Systems Security, covering network security, operating systems security, database protection, cryptography, incident response, and risk governance aligned with industry best practices.
- Designed and supervised hands-on penetration testing and vulnerability assessment labs using Nmap, SQLMap, and John the Ripper to simulate real-world attack scenarios and secure system hardening.
- Led a comprehensive security assessment project identifying 7 critical vulnerabilities, conducting 5 structured risk assessments, and implementing 6 mitigation strategies, resulting in an 80% improvement in system security posture.
- Integrated risk management principles and security control frameworks, enabling structured mapping of vulnerabilities to technical, administrative, and operational controls.
- Incorporated incident detection and response methodologies, emphasizing threat identification, root cause analysis, monitoring concepts, and remediation planning.
- Promoted ethical hacking standards, compliance awareness, and professional cybersecurity reporting while mentoring students in analytical and security-focused decision-making.

ACADEMIC PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Risk Assessment on Acme Coffee Company's system, IIT	Jan. 2024- May.2024
Conducted a penetration test, identified 5 vulnerabilities, provided 2 risk assessments, and delivered 5 recommendations, enhancing security by 90%.	
ISMS Audit for Anthem Inc, Illinois Institute of Technology	Aug .2023 - Dec .2023
Identified and mitigated seven critical vulnerabilities using ISO 27000 and NIST CSF, boosting security by 60% through intrusion detection, security training, and significantly reducing threat risk.	
SQL Injection Vulnerability Analysis, Illinois Institute of Technology	Jan. 2023-May.2023
Identified 4 databases and 15 tables, leading to a 70% improvement in security protocols and reduced risks.	
OSINT Analysis, Illinois Institute of Technology	Jan. 2023 - May 2023
Analyzed public data, improving integrity and security by 40%, generating 15 insights, increasing research efficiency by 30%, and reducing processing time by 25%.	
Financial Discrepancy Investigation for ABC Company, IIT	Aug. 2022-Dec.2022
Investigated financial discrepancies for ABC Company, uncovering an \$8-9 million loss; utilized Win Hex, RGB mapping, and Autopsy to analyze a suspect's USB drive, providing vital evidence that facilitated fund recovery.	
Exposed Major Owl Trafficking Operation, IIT	Aug. 2022-Dec.2022
Conducted a digital investigation, extracting over 50 pieces of key evidence and compiling a detailed 20-page report, leading to the successful prosecution of the trafficking ring.	

ACHIEVEMENTS

Awarded Certified Incident Responder (eCIR) certification	2026
Junior Penetration Tester (eJPT), INE Security	2026
Earned CyberDefense certification, TestOut	2024
CompTIA Security+	2024
Participated in Cybersecurity Incident Response Analysis, STC	2023
Awarded a Saudi Ministry of Education scholarship for U.S. study	2019
Introduction to Cyber Security, simple learning	2019

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

- Member, Women in Cybersecurity (WiCyS)
- Member, OWASP (Open Web Application Security Project)
- Member, Cyber Security Club – King Saud University